Zahin Ahmed

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Education

Queens College, City University of New York (CUNY) — Flushing, NY
B.S. in Computer Science, Concentration in Software Development — *Expected Dec 2027*

- **Relevant Coursework:** Artificial Intelligence, AI/ML, Probability & Statistics, Data Structures, Algorithms, Linear Algebra, Computing in Python, Object-Oriented Programming

CUNY Tech Prep — New York, NY
Full Stack Web Development Fellow, competitive year-long industry training program — *Fall 2026 – Spring 2027*

Experience

Software Engineering Intern — Jun 2026 – Present
Ummah Professionals — *Remote*

- Building the organization's first mentorship platform, replacing a fully manual coordination process for a community of ∼1,000 members, by developing React, Node.js, and MongoDB features across frontend and backend as one of 4 developers
- Automated hand-pairing of mentors and mentees, which previously required staff to read every participant resume, by co-designing a weighted matching algorithm that scores compatibility across 5 dimensions (interest tags, major, university, state, availability), with per-category caps so no single signal dominates
- Built the backend for **Ask Ummah**, an LLM-powered site chatbot, integrating the **Google Gemini** API to retrieve the resources users ask for and return results with 1–2 line summaries
- Integrated third-party services end to end: Google OAuth 2.0 + JWT with role-based access across 3 roles, and the Google Calendar and Meet APIs for automated session links and reminders
- Took on an informal product lead role in week one: ran stand-ups and conducted 20+ user interviews

College Assistant, Financial Aid Office — Jan 2025 – Present
Queens College, CUNY — *Flushing, NY*

- Delivered report-ready datasets each cycle by writing **SQL** queries against CUNYfirst (Oracle-backed student information system) to deduplicate records and join and filter across tables
- Automated manual data compilation by connecting query output directly to Excel for staff use
- Caught input errors before they reached downstream reporting by validating 300+ records per semester

Product Development Intern — Mar 2026 – Jun 2026
Key Path (early-stage fintech startup) — *Remote*

- Coordinated the build of a pre-launch **AI insights feature**, translating stakeholder requirements into technical specs and flagging coverage gaps before development
- Enabled a 5-engineer team (2 frontend, 3 backend) to work from a prioritized backlog by scoping 65+ development tickets in Trello with the product lead
- Surfaced blockers and coordinated frontend/backend handoffs by tracking delivery in daily stand-ups

Projects

HobbyGenie – Hobby-Suggestion Chatbot | *Google Gemini API, React, Vite, MongoDB, JWT* — Aug 2026

- Built an LLM-powered chatbot that suggests personalized hobbies through conversation by integrating the **Google Gemini** API, with a React/Vite frontend and MongoDB for storing user data
- Secured user accounts with Google OAuth, JWT sessions, and role-based access control

SmartSort – AI-Powered Waste Classification App | *React, Tailwind, Firebase, Flask API, PyTorch* — Oct 2025

- Enabled users to sort waste from a single photo, returning a disposal category and estimated carbon footprint per item, by building the React/Tailwind frontend against a teammate-built Flask API serving a PyTorch (MobileNetV2) classifier
- Designed for model failure modes: built error fallbacks for failed or low-confidence predictions and loading feedback during inference for a responsive mobile capture-to-result flow

CashEcho – Voice Bookkeeping App for Small Businesses | *Hack Knight 2026, 48-hour hackathon* — Oct 2026

- Led backend and product on a 3-person team building an app that logs transactions by voice and shows a "debt wall" of upcoming loan payments vs. projected cash; wrote the plan and tickets after a mid-hackathon pivot

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, Java, C++
APIs & Integration: REST APIs, JSON, OAuth 2.0, JWT, Google Calendar & Meet APIs
AI/ML: Google Gemini API, LLM-powered apps (prompting, retrieval, summarization), PyTorch model integration
Backend & Frontend: Node.js, Flask, React, Tailwind CSS, HTML/CSS
Databases & Tools: Oracle, MySQL, MongoDB, Firebase, Git, GitHub, Linux, Excel, Trello, Figma

Leadership & Involvement

Girls Code Club – Member (2024 – Present) | **ACM** – Member (2022 – 2023)